Unfortunately, as they continue with barely concealed exasperation, ‘both the alien Government and the Indian public leaders appeared to have shut their eyes and closed their ears against the existence and the voice of this movement . . .’. The very fact that this statement, even when made, was deliberately erased from the record in 1929, shows the determined effort of both the authorities and other Indian leaders to suppress and to eventually wipe out any trace of what is referred to as the ‘new movement’.

Fourth, there is to be a ‘revolution’. In a vitally important part of the same statement that was expunged by the sessions court, the two of them explain how when, ‘Bhagat Singh was asked in the Lower Court as to what we meant by the word, “Revolution”’ that ‘[i]n answer to the question, I would say that Revolution does not necessarily involve sanguinary strife, nor is there any place in it for individual vendetta’, because ‘[i]t is not the cult of the bomb and the pistol’. So what is it then, one might ask? The answer Bhagat Singh gave was, ‘By Revolution we mean that the present order of things which is based on manifest injustice must change.’ It was against this background, where Bhagat Singh had defined the term ‘revolution’ as the elimination of ‘manifest injustice’, that the obliterated portion of the statement went to prophesy that ‘[t]he whole edifice of this civilisation, if not saved in time, shall crumble’. This is why, ‘A radical change, therefore, is necessary; and it is the duty of those who realise this to reorganise society on the socialistic basis.’ One look at this and one straight away realizes how dramatically different this vision was from that of Mahatma Gandhi, who subsequently became such an icon of the Indian Independence struggle. And yet, it was Bhagat Singh who epitomized the plight of the Indian masses with the excoriating words that:

> Unless this thing is done and the exploitation of man by man and nations by nations, which goes masquerading as Imperialism, is brought to an end, the sufferings and carnage with which humanity is threatened today cannot be prevented and all talks of ending war and ushering in an era of universal peace is undisguised hypocrisy. By Revolution we mean the ultimate establishment of an order of society which may not be threatened by such a break-down, and in which the sovereignty of the proletariat should be recognised, and as the result of which a world-federation should redeem humanity from the bondage of capitalism and the misery of imperial wars.[10]